

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Household forms

JOINT -> multi-generational, may share residence or property

NUCLEAR -> parents and unmarried children in one household

SHARED FEATURE -> obligation can outlive shared residence

RULE -> classify the form, then test the function separately

MUST REMEMBER: Family, household, marriage and kinship are separate but connected institutions organising reproduction, care, property, residence, descent, alliance and identity; nuclearisation, migration, education, work and law alter functions more than they simply dissolve families.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Two kinds of nuclearisation

STRUCTURAL -> separate, smaller household residence

FUNCTIONAL -> independence from support and decision authority

OBSERVED -> structure moves first, function lags behind

ERROR PREVENTED -> reading separate residence as family decline

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Nuclearisation chain

MIGRATION -> employment pulls a unit out of the ancestral home  
HOUSING -> urban cost and space make joint residence impractical  
PERSISTENCE -> remittance and ritual participation continue  
GENERATIONAL DRIFT -> ties weaken for the migrant's children

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Marriage rule stack

ENDOGAMY -> outer boundary is the caste or sub-caste

GOTRA EXOGAMY -> clan lineage excluded inside that boundary

FORMS -> monogamy, arranged, self-choice, rare polygamy

VARIATION -> region, class, education and generation

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Descent systems

PATRILINEAL -> descent, surname and property via the father

MATRILINEAL -> Khasi of Meghalaya, traditionally Nair of Kerala

KHASI DETAIL -> youngest daughter customarily inherits the home

CAUTION -> matrilineal is descent, not matriarchal authority

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Family as transmitter

INPUT -> caste, religious and gender norms of the previous generation

PROCESS -> socialisation of children inside the household

OUTPUT -> reproduction or contestation of those norms

SIGNAL -> social change appears here before it appears in law

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Family is not household, joint is not necessarily co-resident, monogamy is not gender equality, patriarchy is not identical across communities, and patriliney, matriliney, patrilocality, matrilocality, inheritance and authority must be compared on separate axes.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Law against acceptance

DOWRY -> legally prohibited, sociologically persistent

LIVE-IN -> protection expanded faster than social normalisation

CIVIL MARRIAGE -> Special Marriage Act, 1954 route exists

RULE -> a legal route is not a social permission

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Two boundaries compared

INTERCASTE -> parity protects family status and resources

INTERRELIGIOUS -> belonging, kinship and community sanction

TEST -> a civil route exists, so law is not the operative barrier

VERDICT -> different guards produce different speeds



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Work from home audit

GAIN -> presence at home, flexible care, less commuting

STRAIN -> blurred work-care boundary in shared space

INEQUALITY -> domestic labour load reproduced by gender norms

CONDITION -> housing, occupation and control over time decide

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Mediated socialisation test

DISPLACED -> what direct interaction is being replaced

AGE AND CONTEXT -> what the child needs at this stage

MEDIATION -> is an adult present in the digital interaction

GAIN -> contact and learning that would not otherwise occur

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Data boundary

NFHS-5 2019-21 -> national Total Fertility Rate of 2.0

NFHS-6 2023-24 -> released on 29 May 2026

MEASURES -> fertility, not household form or marriage acceptance

RULE -> quote a metric only from its released fact sheet

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Family answer spine

OPEN -> redistribution of functions, not institutional decline

BODY -> residence, obligation, marriage boundary, socialisation

CONDITION -> region, class, gender norms and mediation

CLOSE -> differentiated verdict with the data caveat

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Use Hindu Succession reform, personal-law and Special Marriage Act boundaries with Khasi/Garo, Nair, north Indian and south Indian kinship variation; legal capacity and formal equality must not be reported as automatic bargaining power or social acceptance.